



Soaring high: Navdeep Singh claimed silver in the men's javelin throw F41 event. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

and Sandip, Rinku Hooda won gold in the F46 class (upper limb deficiencies), securing three of India's six gold medals in the competition.

And when Paris Paralympic bronze medallist Hokato Sema fell short of the podium in the F57 category of the men's shot put, India found an able replacement in Soman Rana who took bronze in the same event in New Delhi.

It was not only Indian athletes who impressed. Across 186 medal events over nine days, 35 world records were broken, and 104 championship records were set. While this trend reflects the long-term improvements in participation, coaching, and technology in para sport, it has occurred without any reduction in the spread of medal-winning countries. Of the 100 countries competing in New Delhi, 45 won at least one gold medal, and 64 secured at least one podium finish.

Some of the sport's greats showed why they earned their reputation. Markus Rehm won his eighth individual gold at the Para

Athletics World Championships, setting a championships record of 8.43m in the men's long jump T64.

Switzerland's Catherine Debrunner swept all five golds in the T53 category (for athletes with spinal cord injury who have the use of their arms but limited trunk mobility).

While the performances at the Games themselves lived up to expectations, there were blemishes off the field of play.

While India proved it could organise a world-level event, headlines in the final days highlighted issues such as stray dog bites and empty stadiums.

Great Britain's Hannah Cockroft, who won three gold medals in the women's T34, told reporters, "It was hard to believe" that the Indian public was behind the Games.

These are, of course, issues beyond the athletes' control. At the 2025 World Championships, they focused on what they could achieve.

"These Games have given us a lot of hope. They've shown what we are capable of. We will do even more in the years to come," Simran said after her events.

India's Gold medallists

Name	Event + Category
Simran Sharma	Women's 100m T12
Nishad Kumar	Men's High Jump T47
Sumit Antil	Men's Javelin Throw F64
Sandip Sanjay Sargar	Men's Javelin Throw F44
Rinku Hooda	Men's Javelin Throw F46
Shailesh Kumar	Men's High Jump T63

Silver medallists

Name	Event + Category
Simran Sharma	Women's 200m T12
Preeti Pal	Women's 100m T35
Navdeep	Men's Javelin Throw F41
Ekta Bhyan	Women's Club Throw F51
Dharambir	Men's Club Throw F51
Sandeep	Men's Javelin Throw F44
Yogesh Kathuniya	Men's Discus Throw F56
Sundar Singh Gurjar	Men's Javelin Throw F46
Deepthi Jeevanji	Women's 400m T20

Bronze medallists

Name	Event + Category
Sandeep	Men's 200m T44
Soman Rana	Men's Shot Put F57
Praveen Kumar	Men's High Jump T64
Preeti Pal	Women's 200m T35
Pardeep Kumar	Men's Discus Throw F64
Atul Kaushik	Men's Discus Throw F57
Varun Singh Bhati	Men's High Jump T63